SYNCSALEZ

Product Feature Roadmap

18-Month Execution Plan

Q3 2026 through Q4 2027

CONFIDENTIAL

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Executive Summary

This roadmap sequences 11 new product capabilities, a manufacturer engagement layer, and 32 enhancements to existing modules across six phases over 18 months. Every item is scored by expected impact on the four business goals (grow active users, reduce churn, improve revenue per customer, shorten time to value), estimated effort, and dependency position. The roadmap starts with activation and retention foundations, layers in the revenue engine, then scales into data intelligence, manufacturer engagement, and platform monetization.

Roadmap at a Glance

Phase 1: Foundation	Months 1-3. Onboarding, POS hardening, product database MVP, payment groundwork.
Phase 2: Revenue Engine	Months 4-6. Payments live, storefront MVP, catalogue upgrades, manufacturer promotion engine and content management.
Phase 3: Growth Loop	Months 7-9. Delivery integration, supply chain v1, AI inventory basics, multichannel start, manufacturer promotions live.
Phase 4: Intelligence Layer	Months 10-12. AI merchant analytics, lending pilot, cross-merchant data pipeline, manufacturer dashboard and product launches.
Phase 5: Platform Expansion	Months 13-15. B2B enterprise intelligence pilot, advanced AI, supply chain optimization, manufacturer bundles and rebates.
Phase 6: Data Monetization	Months 16-18. Enterprise intelligence launch, full AI suite, sponsored placement (retail media), full manufacturer self-serve portal.

18-Month Targets

Active Merchants	From current base to 10,000+ monthly active merchants.
Product Database	1,000,000 uniquely identified products.
Churn Rate	Reduce monthly churn by 40% from current baseline.
Revenue per Merchant	3x current ARPU through payments, subscriptions, and lending facilitation.
Time to First Sale	Under 10 minutes from download.
Payment Volume	Process N500M+ monthly transaction volume by Month 12.
Active Manufacturers	30+ manufacturers managing products and running promotions on the platform.
Revenue Streams	Four active streams by Month 18: transaction fees, SaaS subscriptions, data/lending facilitation, and manufacturer engagement (promotions, dashboards, sponsored placement).

Feature Index

This index defines every feature and improvement on the roadmap. Use it as a reference when reading the phase tables. Features are grouped into two sections: new capabilities being added to the platform, and improvements to modules that already exist.

A. New Capabilities

Payment System (Phase 1-2)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
KYC Integration	Identity verification layer using BVN and NIN checks via an API partner (Dojah, YouVerify). Runs during merchant onboarding before any payment feature is activated.	CBN shut down fintechs that skipped KYC. This is a legal prerequisite. Without it, the payment system cannot launch.
Virtual Account Generation	Creates a unique bank account number per transaction or per customer via Paystack or Monnify. When a buyer transfers money, a webhook confirms payment instantly inside the app.	Eliminates fake transfer alerts, the most common payment fraud in Nigerian retail. Removes the wait for SMS bank notifications. Merchants confirmed that instant verification is a top retention driver.
NFC SoftPOS (Tap-to-Pay)	Turns the merchant's NFC-enabled Android phone into a contactless card reader using a certified payment SDK (Paystack Terminal or Flutterwave).	Removes the N50,000+ cost of buying a separate POS terminal. A merchant downloads the app, completes KYC, and accepts card payments within minutes using the phone they already own.
USSD Payment Option	Allows customers without smartphones or bank cards to pay by dialing a short code on any phone.	Extends payment coverage to the large segment of Nigerian buyers who do not carry cards or use banking apps. Widens the merchant's addressable customer base.
Settlement Dashboard	A screen inside the app showing daily payouts, fees deducted, pending settlements, and transaction-level detail.	Merchants need to know exactly how much money is coming and when. Transparency builds trust in the payment system and reduces support tickets.
Geo-Tagging Compliance	Validates the device's GPS coordinates against the merchant's registered address before processing a card transaction.	CBN mandates geo-fencing for POS operations. Failure to comply risks the merchant's terminal ID being blacklisted. This is a regulatory requirement, not a feature choice.

Global Product Database (Phase 1-6)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Product Database MVP	A centralized, curated database starting at 100K products. Each product has a unique	Product setup is the biggest onboarding friction. Typing 200 products manually

	ID, name, photo, category, barcode, and attributes. Merchants search it and tap to add products to their store.	takes hours. Pulling them from a pre-built database takes minutes. This cuts time-to-value from days to under 10 minutes.
Barcode Scan-to-Add	Merchant scans a product's barcode with their phone camera. The database returns the matching product with all details pre-filled. One tap adds it to the merchant's store.	Physical retail runs on barcodes. Scan-to-add is the fastest path from a product on a shelf to a product in the app. It also ensures data accuracy by using the manufacturer's identifier.
Community Contribution	Merchants submit products not found in the database. Submissions enter a moderation queue. Approved products go live and become available to all merchants.	No database covers every product. Community submissions fill gaps, especially for local and regional products. The moderation layer prevents junk data from degrading quality.
Product Identity Graph	Each product in the database carries a canonical ID tracked across the entire SyncSalez ecosystem. When a merchant adds Peak Milk 400g, their local product links to the global ID.	This is the foundation of the data moat. Cross-merchant intelligence, pricing analytics, demand forecasting, and the B2B enterprise product all depend on tracking the same product across thousands of stores.
Product Lifecycle Staging	Tags each product as introduction, growth, maturity, or decline based on velocity trends and merchant adoption rates across the network.	Merchants learn which products are gaining momentum and which are fading. Suppliers see which products need promotion or replacement. Investors see category-level trends.

Storefront / Custom Website Builder (Phase 2-4)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Template Engine	Five to ten mobile-optimized store templates designed for Nigerian retail verticals (grocery, fashion, electronics, pharmacy, food). Merchant selects a template and their products auto-populate.	Gives every merchant a professional online store without hiring a web developer. Templates are pre-designed for mobile because 95%+ of Nigerian internet traffic is mobile.
Free Subdomain	Every merchant gets a live URL at yourshop.syncsalez.com at no cost.	Removes the financial barrier to having an online presence. Every storefront link shared on WhatsApp is also a SyncSalez acquisition channel.
Integrated Checkout	A cart, customer details form, delivery address, and payment flow built into the storefront. Orders flow directly into the merchant's SyncSalez order queue.	Closes the gap between browsing and buying. Without checkout, the storefront is a brochure. With it, the storefront is a sales channel.
Inventory Sync	The storefront pulls live stock levels from SyncSalez. A product sold in-store is immediately hidden or marked out-of-stock online.	Prevents overselling, the fastest way to destroy customer trust. One inventory count feeds all channels.
Custom Domain Support	Merchants connect their own domain (e.g., ngozishop.com). SyncSalez handles DNS configuration, SSL certificates, and hosting.	A custom domain elevates merchant credibility and brand identity. It is also a clear monetization upsell on a premium subscription tier.

Visual Customizer	A touch-friendly editor where merchants drag and drop their logo, banner image, brand colors, and product layout. No code required.	Merchants want their store to look like theirs, not a generic template. Customization drives ownership, which drives retention.
SEO Tools	Auto-generated meta tags, Google indexing submission, and Open Graph previews for WhatsApp and social media sharing.	Organic search traffic is free acquisition. A storefront that appears in Google search generates orders without any marketing spend.
Abandoned Cart Tracking	Records when a buyer adds products to their storefront cart but does not complete checkout. Surfaces these abandoned carts to the merchant.	Industry-wide, 70% of online carts are abandoned. Even recovering 5% of abandoned carts adds incremental revenue at zero acquisition cost.

Delivery Integration System (Phase 3-5)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Delivery Provider API	A standard interface that third-party delivery companies (Gokada, Kwik, Chowdeck, local dispatch riders) integrate against. Endpoints cover pickup requests, price quotes, tracking, and delivery confirmation.	The storefront and catalogue generate orders, but fulfillment is a gap. Without a delivery layer, merchants coordinate manually via phone calls and WhatsApp, which is slow and error-prone.
Multi-Provider Routing	Merchant sets preferences (cheapest, fastest, preferred provider). The system requests quotes from connected providers and auto-selects or lets the merchant choose.	Competition between providers lowers delivery costs and improves speed. The merchant gets the best deal without calling three different riders.
Real-Time Tracking	Customer and merchant both see the rider's location on a map. Push notifications fire at key stages: rider assigned, picked up, en route, delivered.	Reduces customer anxiety and support inquiries (where is my order?). Builds buyer confidence in ordering from SyncSalez storefronts.
Proof of Delivery	Photo confirmation, digital signature, or OTP verification at the dropoff point.	Eliminates disputes about whether an order was delivered. Creates an auditable record for both merchant and customer.
Dispatch Rider Self-Onboarding	A portal where independent riders and small dispatch companies register, verify their identity, and start receiving delivery requests.	Expands delivery coverage beyond the large platforms. In many Nigerian neighborhoods, local dispatch riders are faster and cheaper than corporate fleets.
Returns and Failed Delivery	Workflow for when the customer is unavailable or rejects the order. Auto-triggers return to merchant and restocking in inventory.	Without a returns workflow, failed deliveries create inventory confusion and financial losses. Automation keeps stock records accurate.

Supply Chain Network (Phase 3-5)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Supplier Discovery	Merchant searches for any product and sees a list of verified distributors who stock it, with prices, minimum order quantities, delivery areas, and ratings.	Most micro-retailers buy from whichever supplier shows up. Discovery gives them visibility into alternatives, which drives better prices and more reliable supply.
Purchase Order Creation	Merchant builds a purchase order inside SyncSalez and sends it to the supplier digitally or via WhatsApp. Supplier confirms, ships, and the merchant reconciles against the PO.	Replaces phone calls, notebooks, and memory. Creates an auditable paper trail for every purchase. Enables the 3-way matching that large retailers use to prevent supplier fraud.
Auto-Reorder Triggers	When stock hits a merchant-defined threshold, the system drafts a purchase order to the assigned supplier. One tap to confirm and send.	Prevents stockouts caused by forgetting to reorder. Stockouts cost global retail $1.14 trillion annually. Automated triggers close the gap between knowing stock is low and acting on it.

Supplier Reliability Scoring	Rates each supplier on on-time delivery rate, order accuracy, lead time consistency, and price competitiveness based on PO history.	Merchants make supplier decisions based on data instead of habit. Unreliable suppliers become visible. Good suppliers get rewarded with more orders.
3-Way Matching	Automatically compares the purchase order, the delivery receipt, and the supplier invoice. Flags discrepancies in quantity, price, or items.	This is the anti-fraud mechanism that Shoprite runs on SAP. Adapted for micro-retailers, it catches overcharging, short deliveries, and invoice manipulation immediately.
Supplier Onboarding Portal	Distributors and manufacturers register, list their products, set pricing, and receive orders directly through SyncSalez.	Creates a two-sided marketplace. Suppliers gain access to thousands of small retailers. Merchants gain access to verified suppliers. SyncSalez earns a transaction fee on each order.

AI-Powered Merchant Analytics (Phase 4-6)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Demand Prediction	Forecasts future sales for each product based on the merchant's own history, seasonal patterns, and cross-merchant velocity data. Tells the merchant what to restock and when.	Replaces guesswork with data-driven ordering. Amazon's version delivers 10-20% forecast improvement. For a small retailer, even a rough forecast prevents the two costliest errors: stockouts and overstock.
Pricing Recommendations	Compares the merchant's prices against other merchants selling the same product in the same area. Suggests price adjustments with estimated margin impact.	Most merchants set prices once and forget. Cross-merchant pricing data reveals when a merchant is leaving money on the table or pricing themselves out of the market.
Product Recommendations	Surfaces products that similar merchants sell successfully but this merchant does not stock. Includes estimated weekly revenue based on comparable stores.	Expands the merchant's product range based on proven demand from peers. This is the same model Faire uses to connect 700,000+ retailers with 100,000+ brands.
Anomaly Alerts	Detects unusual drops in sales, spikes in returns, or inventory discrepancies and pushes an alert to the merchant within hours.	Problems caught on the same day they occur are fixable. Problems discovered at month-end are losses. Early alerts shrink the damage window.
Weekly Summary (Plain Language)	A push notification summarizing the week's performance: total revenue, top seller, best margin product, trend vs. last week. Written in simple, direct language.	Most merchants will not open a dashboard. A push notification meets them where they are. Plain language ensures comprehension regardless of literacy level.
Conversational AI Assistant	A chat interface inside the app where merchants ask questions in natural language or voice. Trained on the merchant's own data and cross-merchant intelligence.	Removes the need to navigate screens and read charts. The merchant asks a question and gets an answer. Voice input makes it accessible to merchants who do not read comfortably.
Promotional Effectiveness	Compares sales of the same product across merchants running different promotions vs. none. Measures actual lift without requiring controlled experiments.	Merchants spend money on promotions without knowing the return. This tells them which promotions worked and by

		how much, using the natural variation across the network.

Cross-Merchant Data Intelligence (Phase 4-6)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Cross-Merchant Data Pipeline	An aggregation layer that collects, normalizes, and analyzes product-level transaction data across all merchants on the platform. Every sale tagged to a global product ID feeds the pipeline.	This is the engine behind all intelligence features. Without it, analytics are limited to each merchant's own data. With it, SyncSalez sees the entire market.
Pricing Dispersion Analysis	Calculates the price range, median, and distribution for every product across all merchants, segmented by geography and merchant type.	Feeds pricing recommendations for merchants. Feeds competitive intelligence for the B2B enterprise product. Reveals margin opportunities invisible to individual sellers.
Seasonal Pattern Detection	Identifies cyclical demand patterns by analyzing 12+ months of aggregated sales data across merchants and categories.	Seasonal stocking errors cost retailers billions globally. Accurate seasonal signals help merchants stock up before demand peaks and avoid overstocking after peaks pass.
Merchant Performance Benchmarks	Ranks each merchant on conversion rate, average order value, fulfillment speed, and retention against similar stores in the same category and location.	Shopify does this for its 5.6 million merchants. It gives each merchant context: am I performing above or below average, and in which areas? Context motivates action.

B2B Enterprise Intelligence Product (Phase 5-6)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Self-Serve Dashboard	A web application where enterprise customers (FMCG brands, distributors, investors) filter and explore aggregated, anonymized market data by product category, geography, and time period.	The entry point for enterprise customers. Self-serve access reduces sales friction. Instacart's comparable product (Consumer Insights Portal) serves brands like Coca-Cola across nearly 100,000 stores.
Custom Reports	Analyst-prepared reports on demand trends, pricing dynamics, category performance, and competitive product analysis tailored to a specific client's questions.	Premium service tier. Enterprise customers pay more for curated analysis than raw dashboards. Custom reports demonstrate value and justify higher subscription pricing.
Enterprise API Access	An API that enterprise customers connect to their own BI tools (Tableau, Power BI, Looker) to ingest SyncSalez market data into their existing analytics workflows.	Large companies do not adopt standalone dashboards for every data source. API access meets them where they work and embeds SyncSalez data into their decision-making infrastructure.
Clean Room Capability	A secure environment where brands merge their own first-party data (e.g., marketing spend, ad impressions) with SyncSalez transaction signals to build custom audiences and measure campaign effectiveness.	Follows the Instacart Data Hub model. Clean rooms allow brands to enrich their own data without either party exposing raw records. This is the highest-value tier of the enterprise product.

Merchant Lending / Credit Access (Phase 4-5)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Merchant Credit Score	A scoring model derived from the merchant's SyncSalez data: monthly revenue trend (6-month minimum), transaction frequency, inventory turnover, customer retention, and debt repayment history.	Banks do not lend to micro-retailers because they lack formal records. SyncSalez replaces paper records with verified digital data. Square used this model to disburse $32 billion+ at a 4% default rate vs. the 8% industry average.
Lending Partner API	An API that 2-3 microfinance banks query to pull a merchant's credit score and supporting data. The bank makes the lending decision and disburses the loan.	SyncSalez provides data, the bank provides capital. No balance sheet risk for SyncSalez. Revenue comes from a facilitation fee per loan originated.
In-App Loan Application	A screen inside SyncSalez where merchants apply for a loan, see their eligibility, and track their loan status. Integrated with the partner bank's system.	Removes friction from the lending process. The merchant does not visit a bank branch or fill out paper forms. One tap applies. The data does the talking.

AI-Assisted Inventory Management (Phase 3-5)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Rule-Based Reorder Alerts	Automated alerts that fire when stock drops below a merchant-defined threshold. The alert includes the product, current stock, sell-through rate, and a pre-drafted purchase order.	The simplest form of inventory automation. No AI required. Delivers immediate value from day one. Prevents stockouts caused by forgetting to check stock levels.
Expiry Markdown Suggestions	For perishable products, the system calculates days-to-expiry and suggests a discount percentage that would clear remaining stock before the expiry date based on the merchant's sales velocity.	Expired goods are a direct financial loss. A timely discount recovers some revenue. The suggestion is based on data, not guesswork.
Shrinkage Trend Analysis	After every stock take, calculates the variance between expected and counted stock. Tracks variance trends over time by product category, day of week, and staff shift.	Theft is a top concern for Nigerian retailers. Single stock counts catch one-time discrepancies. Trend analysis reveals patterns: which products go missing, when, and how often.
ML Demand Forecasting	Machine learning models trained on 12+ months of the merchant's sales data and cross-merchant patterns. Replaces rule-based alerts with predictive forecasts at 7-day and 30-day horizons.	Rule-based alerts react to the present. ML forecasting anticipates the future. Even modest accuracy improvements translate to fewer stockouts and less capital trapped in slow-moving inventory.
Seasonal Pre-Stocking Alerts	Alerts sent 30 days before a predicted seasonal demand peak, based on the prior year's cross-merchant data. Includes recommended order quantities.	Seasonal peaks (Ramadan, Christmas, back-to-school) are predictable but often missed. A 30-day lead time gives merchants time to order and receive stock before the rush.
Dead Stock Identification	Flags products that have not sold in 60+ days. Suggests clearance pricing, bundle deals, or return-to-supplier based on remaining value and shelf space cost.	Dead stock ties up capital and occupies shelf space. Identifying it early frees cash for products that move.
Cold-Start Demand Estimation	When a merchant adds a new product, the system estimates initial demand based on	Solves the new-product problem. Without this, merchants guess how

	how similar merchants perform with that product. No sales history required.	much to order. With it, they get a data-backed starting point from the network.
FIFO Enforcement	Prompts the POS to prioritize selling older stock batches first for perishable products. Links to batch expiry dates recorded in the inventory module.	First-in-first-out is a standard inventory practice. Enforcing it in software prevents staff from grabbing the newest stock while older stock expires in the back.

AI-Assisted Multichannel Sales (Phase 3-6)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
WhatsApp Commerce	Receives customer orders via WhatsApp. The app auto-suggests replies with product details, price, and availability. The merchant confirms and the order enters the SyncSalez queue.	WhatsApp is the primary commerce channel for Nigerian merchants. Formalizing WhatsApp orders into the SyncSalez system eliminates lost orders, forgotten details, and manual tracking.
Unified Order Queue	All orders from all channels (POS walk-in, storefront, WhatsApp, catalogue) appear in a single list with channel tags. Fulfillment is managed from one screen.	Without unification, the merchant checks multiple places for orders. Items get missed. A single queue eliminates channel blindness.
Instagram/Facebook Shop Sync	Products listed in SyncSalez auto-publish to the merchant's social media shop pages. Price and stock updates propagate automatically.	Social media is a primary discovery channel. Manual product posting is tedious and error-prone. Auto-sync keeps social shops current without extra effort from the merchant.
AI Product Listing	Merchant takes a photo of a product. AI generates a title, description, and suggested price for each channel, formatted appropriately (short for WhatsApp, visual for Instagram, detailed for storefront).	Listing creation is a chore that most merchants skip. AI reduces listing time from minutes to seconds. Better listings drive more sales.
Channel Performance Analytics	Shows revenue split by channel, conversion rate per channel, and identifies which products perform best on which channel.	Helps merchants allocate effort to the channels that generate the most return. Reveals underperforming channels that need attention or should be deprioritized.
Smart Channel Allocation	AI recommends which products to promote on which channel based on historical performance, product type, and audience behavior.	Takes channel optimization from manual analysis to automated recommendations. Tested against control groups to validate lift.
Buyer-Facing Chatbot	An automated responder on the storefront and WhatsApp that answers buyer questions about product availability, pricing, and order status without merchant intervention.	Merchants miss orders because they cannot respond fast enough. The chatbot handles the 30% of queries that are routine, freeing the merchant for conversations that require judgment.

Manufacturer Engagement Layer (Phase 2-6)

A controlled set of tools that allow product manufacturers to influence how their products are sold, priced, displayed, and promoted across the SyncSalez merchant network. The manufacturer requests, funds, and measures. The merchant accepts, rejects, or ignores. Every manufacturer action requires merchant consent.

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Manufacturer-Funded Promotions	The manufacturer creates a time-bound discount on a product, funds it from a pre-loaded wallet, and targets a geographic area or merchant segment. The promotion syncs to eligible merchants who opt in. The discounted price applies at POS checkout. Every redemption is logged and attributed.	Manufacturers spend billions on trade promotions with zero ROI measurement. SyncSalez tracks every redemption by store, geography, and time. The manufacturer sees actual lift. The merchant's margin is protected because the manufacturer absorbs the discount. This is the entry product for the entire layer.
Product Content Management	The manufacturer claims ownership of their products in the global database (verified via business registration). Once verified, they manage product images, descriptions, specifications, and packaging details. Changes propagate across all merchants who stock the product.	The manufacturer is the authoritative source of product data. Better images and descriptions improve every merchant's catalogue and storefront without the merchant doing any work. This is a pure quality improvement for the entire network.
Manufacturer Sales Dashboard	A web portal showing aggregated, anonymized performance data for the manufacturer's products across the SyncSalez network. Metrics: units sold, velocity trend, geographic distribution, price distribution, stock-out frequency, and category market share.	Gives manufacturers visibility into the micro-retail channel they have never had. No individual merchant names or customer data exposed. Aggregated data protects privacy while delivering market intelligence. This is a subset of the B2B Enterprise Intelligence product.
Recommended Retail Price (RRP)	The manufacturer sets a suggested selling price for each product. The RRP appears in the merchant's product detail screen as a reference point alongside the cross-merchant average price. No enforcement. The merchant sets their own price.	Many Nigerian merchants ask distributors what price to charge. The RRP answers this inside the app. Useful for new products where the merchant has no pricing history. Two reference points (manufacturer suggestion + market average) help the merchant make informed pricing decisions.
New Product Launch Distribution	The manufacturer selects a new product, defines a target merchant segment, and sends an invitation with introductory terms (discount, samples, favorable pricing). Eligible merchants receive a notification and tap to accept or decline. Accepted products auto-add from the global database.	Controlled distribution replaces the randomness of distributor push. The manufacturer tracks adoption in real time: how many merchants accepted, ordered, and started selling. Merchants get early access to new products with favorable terms.
Marketing Asset Library	The manufacturer uploads digital marketing materials (product photos, social media templates, WhatsApp images, storefront banners, short videos) tagged to specific products. Merchants who stock the product see these assets and share them to their channels with one tap.	Professional marketing content is expensive. Most micro-retailers post blurry photos. Manufacturer-provided assets are free, professional, and brand-accurate. The merchant looks more credible. The manufacturer maintains brand consistency across thousands of stores.

Sponsored Placement	The manufacturer bids for premium placement: top of search results, featured product on storefront homepages, recommended product in the POS selection screen. Merchants opt in and earn a share of placement revenue. Cost-per-impression or cost-per-click model.	This is the retail media network model (Instacart Ads, Amazon Advertising, Walmart Connect). It is the highest-revenue-potential feature in this layer but requires platform scale (10,000+ merchants, 2,000+ storefronts with buyer traffic).
Bundle and Cross-Sell Programs	The manufacturer defines recommended product pairings and funds a bundle discount. The bundle appears as a suggestion in the merchant's POS or storefront. The merchant opts in and the bundle applies at checkout.	Drives cross-category purchases. Moves slower products by pairing them with fast movers. Classic trade marketing tactic digitized with full redemption tracking.
Manufacturer-to-Merchant Messaging	A messaging channel for manufacturers to send targeted messages to merchants who stock their products. Covers promotion announcements, product recalls, reorder reminders, and seasonal marketing tips. Frequency-capped and opt-in.	Direct communication between manufacturer and retailer. Currently this requires distributor intermediation. Frequency caps and opt-in protect merchants from spam.
Rebate and Volume Incentive Programs	The manufacturer sets a volume target for a merchant segment. Merchants who sell X units within a time period earn a cash rebate. Progress tracking is visible inside the app.	Incentivizes volume at the retail level without distributor intermediation. Creates loyalty between manufacturer and merchant. The merchant sees their progress and is motivated to reach the target.

B. Improvements to Existing Modules

Onboarding (New Module)

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Guided Setup Wizard	A step-by-step walkthrough: add 5 products from the global database, make a test sale, invite a customer. Each step has clear instructions and a completion indicator.	Onboarding drop-off is the single largest source of user loss. Guided setup reduces cognitive load and ensures every merchant reaches the activation milestone.
Demo Store Mode	A pre-loaded store with sample products, customers, and transactions. The merchant explores every feature without committing real data.	Removes the fear of making mistakes. The merchant sees the value of the app before investing time in setup. Proven to increase onboarding completion in B2B SaaS.
Progress Indicators	A percentage bar showing how far through setup the merchant is. Next-step prompts surface the single most important remaining action.	Progress bars create completion motivation. Merchants who see 60% complete are more likely to finish than merchants who see an open-ended setup list.

POS Module

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters

Voice Confirmation (TTS)	After a payment is recorded, the app speaks the amount aloud: 'Payment of Five Thousand Naira received.' Uses text-to-speech.	Builds trust for merchants with low literacy. Confirms the amount without requiring the merchant to read the screen. Also useful in noisy market environments.
Bluetooth Thermal Printer	Support for generic ESC/POS thermal printers connected via Bluetooth. Prints a receipt after each sale.	In Nigeria, a physical receipt is often the only proof of purchase a customer accepts. The connection logic must handle the flakiness of cheap generic printers common in the market.
Quick Sale Mode	A one-tap sale flow for a single item with cash payment. Skips the full cart, customer selection, and payment method screens.	Designed for high-traffic moments when a customer buys one item and pays cash. Cuts checkout from 30+ seconds to under 5 seconds.
Cash Drawer Reconciliation	Merchant counts physical cash, enters the number. The app compares it to recorded cash sales for the day and flags any discrepancy.	Daily cash reconciliation catches errors and theft on the same day they occur, not at month-end. A simple tool that builds financial discipline.

Products Module

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Barcode Generation + Printing	Generates barcode labels for products that do not have one. Prints labels via Bluetooth thermal printer.	Products without barcodes (homemade goods, repackaged items, local brands) need an identifier for scanning. Printed labels professionalize the merchant's operation.
Bulk Import via CSV	Upload a spreadsheet of products (name, price, category, barcode) and create them all at once.	Merchants migrating from another system or from paper need a fast way to load hundreds of SKUs without typing each one individually.
Product Auto-Fill from Database	When adding a product from the global database, the photo, name, category, barcode, and suggested price pre-fill automatically.	Reduces a 2-minute manual entry to a 5-second tap. The biggest single improvement to time-to-value during setup.
Product Performance Score	A red/yellow/green indicator per product showing margin health, sales velocity, and stock status at a glance on the product list.	Gives merchants a fast visual signal about which products are performing and which need attention. Removes the need to open analytics reports.

Stock and Inventory Module

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Stock Value Dashboard	Displays the total naira value of current inventory, broken down by category.	Merchants need to understand how much capital is sitting on their shelves. This is a basic financial awareness tool that most micro-retailers have never had.
Shrinkage Reporting	After each stock take, auto-calculates variance between expected and counted stock. Shows a monthly trend line.	Moves beyond one-time stock count results to ongoing shrinkage monitoring. Trends reveal whether

		shrinkage is improving, worsening, or concentrated in specific categories.

Customers Module

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
WhatsApp Messaging	One-tap actions to send a receipt, payment reminder, or promotion to a customer's WhatsApp directly from the app.	WhatsApp is the communication backbone for Nigerian commerce. In-app integration removes the need to switch to WhatsApp, copy-paste, and manually format messages.
Automated Debt Reminders	Merchant sets a schedule (e.g., 7 days overdue). The app sends a polite WhatsApp message to the customer with the outstanding balance.	Debt collection is awkward and often delayed. Automation ensures reminders go out on time, every time, without the merchant initiating each one.
Customer Segmentation	Tag customers as wholesale, retail, VIP, or custom labels. Filter and run bulk actions per segment.	Different customers need different treatment. Segmentation enables targeted promotions, tiered pricing, and prioritized service for high-value accounts.
Customer Lifetime Value	Displays total revenue generated by each customer over their entire history with the merchant.	Identifies the top 10% of customers who generate disproportionate value. Helps merchants decide where to invest relationship effort.

Orders Module

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Order-to-Delivery Handoff	When an order is marked ready, a single tap triggers the delivery system to request a rider pickup.	Bridges the gap between order completion and fulfillment. Removes the manual step of calling a rider separately.
Repeat Order Templates	For B2B customers who order the same items weekly, the merchant saves an order template and resubmits with one tap.	B2B reordering is repetitive. Templates cut reorder time from minutes to seconds and reduce errors from retyping the same items.
Order Source Tracking	Every order is tagged by its origin channel: walk-in, WhatsApp, storefront, catalogue.	Feeds multichannel analytics. Merchants see which channels generate the most orders and revenue. Essential for channel investment decisions.

Dashboard and Analytics

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Top Products Card (Enabled)	Re-enables the Top Products analytics card on the dashboard for all merchants. The underlying query is optimized for performance on low-end devices.	This was disabled for performance reasons. The insight (which products sell most) is too valuable to suppress.

		The fix is to optimize the query, not remove the feature.
Weekly Summary Push	A push notification delivered once per week with total sales, percentage change vs. prior week, and top-selling product.	Keeps merchants engaged even when they do not open the app. A positive summary reinforces value. A declining trend prompts action.
Profit Margin Tracking	Shows gross margin per product and per day. Calculates selling price minus cost price for every transaction.	Revenue is not profit. Most micro-retailers do not track margins. This feature surfaces the number that matters: how much money the merchant keeps.
Comparison View	Side-by-side display of this week vs. last week, or this month vs. last month, for key metrics.	Trends are invisible without comparison. A single number (N300,000 this week) means nothing. A comparison (N300,000 this week, up 14%) tells a story.
Benchmarking Panel	Shows the merchant how they rank against similar stores in their category and location across key metrics.	Shopify describes this as intelligence no individual merchant could generate alone. It creates motivation (am I above or below average?) and identifies specific areas for improvement.

Catalogue Module

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Catalogue Analytics	Tracks how many times a catalogue link was opened, which products were viewed most, and which generated orders.	Turns the catalogue from a broadcast tool into a measurable sales channel. Merchants see ROI on every catalogue they share.
Request Restock Button	Buyers browsing the catalogue see a button on out-of-stock products to request the merchant restock it.	Captures demand signals for products the merchant does not currently have. The merchant sees real demand before committing capital to reorder.
Open Graph Meta Tags	Auto-generates rich previews (product image, price, store name) when catalogue links are shared on WhatsApp, Facebook, or Instagram.	A link shared without a preview looks like spam. A link shared with a product photo and price looks like a store. Preview cards increase click-through rates on shared links.

Messaging and Chat

Feature / Deliverable	What It Is	Why It Matters
Canned Responses	Pre-written replies for common situations: order ready, out of stock, payment received, delivery scheduled.	Reduces response time by 40%+ for routine messages. Ensures consistent, professional communication without typing each reply from scratch.
Order Context in Chat	When a customer messages about an order, the order details (items, status, amount) appear inline in the chat thread.	Eliminates screen-switching. The merchant reads the message and sees the order details in the same view, enabling faster and more accurate responses.

Strategic Context

Business Goals

All prioritization decisions flow from four business goals, ranked by current urgency.

1. Shorten time to value	A merchant who completes their first real sale within 10 minutes of download is 4x more likely to be active at day 30. Onboarding friction is the largest single driver of early drop-off.
2. Reduce churn	Once a merchant uploads 200+ products and processes 30+ sales, switching cost becomes high. The goal is to move merchants past this threshold within the first 14 days.
3. Grow active users	Paid acquisition is constrained by budget. Growth depends on organic channels: referrals, market-level word of mouth, WhatsApp sharing, and the catalogue/storefront as a viral loop.
4. Improve revenue per customer	Transaction fees from the payment system become the primary revenue engine. Subscription tiers, lending facilitation fees, and premium features (custom domains, advanced analytics) layer on top.

Prioritization Framework

Each feature is scored on three dimensions. Impact is weighted 50%, effort 30%, dependency 20%. Impact is measured against the four business goals. Effort is estimated in engineering-months. Dependency captures what must ship before a feature becomes viable.

Score	Impact	Effort	Dependency	Confidence	Priority
5	Moves 2+ goals by 10%+	< 1 eng-month	No blockers	Validated by data	Ship immediately
3	Moves 1 goal by 5-10%	1-3 eng-months	1 prerequisite	Strong hypothesis	Schedule in quarter
1	Indirect or deferred	3+ eng-months	2+ prerequisites	Speculative	Backlog / later phase

Constraints

Budget limits on paid acquisition. Mobile-first user base on low-end Android (Tecno, Infinix). Low tech literacy among many users. Offline-first is non-negotiable. Every feature must work on 2GB RAM devices over unstable networks. Messaging must be simple, direct, and outcome-focused.

Phase 1: Foundation

Months 1-3 | *Theme: Activate faster, retain longer, prepare revenue infrastructure.*

This phase addresses the two highest-leverage problems: merchants drop off during onboarding, and the POS lacks payment integration. Every item in Phase 1 either reduces time to first sale or lays groundwork for the payment system that will drive revenue starting in Phase 2.

> Phase 1 Outcome Target: Reduce median time to first sale from current baseline to under 10 minutes. Achieve 60% day-7 activation rate (defined as merchant completing 5+ real sales).

Feature / Deliverable	Type	Month	Success Metric	Dependency
Onboarding wizard (guided setup: add 5 products, first test sale, first customer)	Improvement	1	Day-7 activation rate > 60%	None
Demo store mode (pre-loaded sample products)	Improvement	1	Onboarding completion rate +20%	None
Progress indicators (setup completion %)	Improvement	1	Step 3 drop-off rate < 15%	None
Global Product Database MVP (100K products, search, barcode scan-to-add)	New Feature	1-3	Avg. product setup time < 30 sec	None
Product auto-fill from database (photo, name, category, barcode)	Improvement	2	Manual entry reduced by 70%	Product DB MVP
Bulk product import via CSV	Improvement	2	Migration merchants onboard in < 1 hour	None
POS: Quick sale mode (one-tap, cash-only, single item)	Improvement	2	Checkout time < 5 seconds	None
POS: Bluetooth thermal printer support	Improvement	2	Receipt print success rate > 90%	None
POS: Voice confirmation of payment (TTS)	Improvement	3	User satisfaction score for low-literacy segment	None
POS: Cash drawer reconciliation tool	Improvement	3	Cash variance detection within same day	None
Payment system: KYC integration (BVN + NIN)	New Feature	2-3	KYC completion rate > 80%	Identity API partner
Payment system: Virtual account generation (Paystack/Monnify)	New Feature	3	API integration live, sandbox tested	KYC integration
Payment system: Geo-tagging compliance module	New Feature	3	GPS validation pass rate > 95%	None

Data pipeline: Begin collecting product-level transaction data with global IDs	Infrastructure	1-3	100% of sales tagged to global product ID	Product DB MVP
Dashboard: Enable Top Products card (optimize query)	Improvement	1	Card loads in < 500ms	None
Stock: Stock value dashboard (total naira value of inventory)	Improvement	2	Merchant views inventory value daily	None

Phase 1 Decision Gate (End of Month 3)

Month	Milestone	Gate Criteria	Decision If Not Met
3	Day-7 activation rate reaches 60%	Measured across 500+ new signups	Iterate onboarding; delay Phase 2 non-payment items by 2 weeks
3	Product database has 100K+ products	Data quality audit: 95%+ accuracy on top 10K SKUs	Narrow to top 3 verticals; accelerate data ingestion partnerships
3	Payment sandbox testing complete	All payment methods pass end-to-end test	Extend testing by 4 weeks; do not launch payments with known failures
3	Bluetooth printer works on top 5 Transsion devices	Field test with 50 merchants	Publish supported device list; exclude unsupported models from marketing

Phase 2: Revenue Engine

Months 4-6 | *Theme: Turn transactions into revenue. Launch the storefront. Make analytics useful.*

Phase 2 activates the payment system for live merchants, launches the storefront MVP, and upgrades analytics. The payment system is the primary revenue engine. The storefront creates a viral acquisition loop (every store link shared on WhatsApp is a SyncSalez ad). Analytics improvements reduce churn by showing merchants the value they get from the product.

> Phase 2 Outcome Target: Process N50M+ in monthly payment volume. Launch 500+ merchant storefronts. Reduce Month-2 churn by 15% from baseline. 10+ manufacturers verified and managing product content. Promotion engine tested in sandbox.

Feature / Deliverable	Type	Month	Success Metric	Dependency
Payment system LIVE: Virtual account (pay-with-transfer, auto-confirm)	New Feature	4	N50M monthly volume by Month 6	Phase 1 KYC + sandbox
Payment system: NFC SoftPOS (tap-to-pay on Android)	New Feature	5	500+ NFC transactions/month	Payment system live
Payment system: USSD payment option	New Feature	5	Covers non-smartphone customers	Payment system live
Payment system: Settlement dashboard	New Feature	5	Daily payout visibility for merchants	Payment system live
Storefront MVP: Template engine (5 mobile-optimized templates)	New Feature	4-5	500 storefronts created by Month 6	None
Storefront: Free subdomain (yourshop.syncsalez.com)	New Feature	5	Every new merchant gets a live URL	Template engine
Storefront: Integrated checkout (cart, payment, order queue)	New Feature	5-6	10% of storefront visitors complete checkout	Payment system live
Storefront: Inventory sync (POS sale hides out-of-stock online)	New Feature	6	Zero oversell incidents	Template engine
Catalogue: Analytics (views, clicks, orders generated)	Improvement	4	Merchants see catalogue ROI	None
Catalogue: Request restock button for buyers	Improvement	4	Demand signal captured for out-of-stock items	None
Catalogue: Open Graph meta tags for WhatsApp preview	Improvement	4	Shared links show product image + price	None
Dashboard: Weekly summary push notification	Improvement	4	Open rate > 40%	None

Dashboard: Profit margin tracking (per product, per day)	Improvement	5	Merchants identify top 5 margin products	None
Dashboard: Comparison view (this week vs. last week)	Improvement	5	Trend visibility in 2 taps	None
Customers: WhatsApp messaging (receipt, reminder, promo)	Improvement	5	50%+ merchants send 1+ WhatsApp via app/week	None
Customers: Automated debt reminders on schedule	Improvement	6	Debt collection rate improves 20%	WhatsApp integration
Customers: Segmentation by tags (wholesale, retail, VIP)	Improvement	6	Merchants create 2+ segments	None
Product database: Scale to 300K products	Infrastructure	4-6	Top 5 retail verticals covered at 90%+	Phase 1 DB MVP
Product database: Community contribution with moderation queue	Infrastructure	6	500+ merchant submissions/month	Phase 1 DB MVP
Manufacturer: Promotion engine (create, fund, target, schedule promotions)	New Feature	5-6	Promotion engine functional in sandbox	Payment system + Product DB
Manufacturer: Promotion wallet (pre-fund, deduct per redemption, settle)	New Feature	6	Financial reconciliation passes audit	Payment system live
Manufacturer: Product Content Management (claim products, manage images/descriptions)	New Feature	5	10+ manufacturers verified and managing content	Product DB at 300K

Phase 2 Decision Gate (End of Month 6)

Month	Milestone	Gate Criteria	Decision If Not Met
6	Payment volume reaches N50M/month	Measured from live transaction logs	Increase merchant activation push; review payment UX for drop-off points
6	500+ active storefronts	Active = received 1+ order in last 30 days	Simplify storefront setup; add setup wizard
6	Product database at 300K products	Quality audit on random sample of 1,000 products	Prioritize FMCG and pharmacy verticals; pause lower-demand categories
6	Weekly push notification open rate > 40%	Measured via notification analytics	Test message variants; adjust send timing to merchant peak hours
6	10+ manufacturers verified and managing product content	Manufacturer accounts active in content management system	Increase outreach to top FMCG brand managers;

			offer white-glove onboarding for first 20 manufacturers
6	Promotion engine functional in sandbox with wallet settlement	End-to-end test: create promotion, fund wallet, redeem at POS, settle to merchant	If settlement logic fails audit, delay manufacturer promotions launch by 4 weeks; fix reconciliation first

Phase 3: Growth Loop

Months 7-9 | *Theme: Close the fulfillment gap. Connect supply to demand. Start the AI layer.*

The storefront generates orders. Delivery integration fulfills them. The supply chain module connects merchants to suppliers. AI inventory management begins with rule-based automation before models are trained. WhatsApp commerce integration opens the highest-volume sales channel for Nigerian merchants.

> Phase 3 Outcome Target: 100+ deliveries fulfilled through the platform per week. 1,000+ purchase orders created via supply chain module. WhatsApp order flow live for 500+ merchants. 5+ manufacturer promotions live with 1,000+ monthly redemptions.

Feature / Deliverable	Type	Month	Success Metric	Dependency
Delivery: Provider API (request pickup, get quote, track, confirm)	New Feature	7	3+ delivery providers integrated	Storefront live
Delivery: Multi-provider routing (cheapest, fastest, preferred)	New Feature	8	Merchant selects provider in < 2 taps	Provider API
Delivery: Real-time tracking (customer + merchant see rider)	New Feature	8	Tracking accuracy within 500m	Provider API
Delivery: Proof of delivery (photo, OTP)	New Feature	9	95%+ delivery confirmation rate	Tracking live
Supply chain: Supplier discovery (search, compare, ratings)	New Feature	7-8	500+ verified suppliers listed	Product DB at 300K
Supply chain: Purchase order creation and send via WhatsApp	New Feature	8	1,000+ POs created/month	Supplier discovery
Supply chain: Auto-reorder triggers at stock threshold	Improvement	9	Stockout rate drops 20%	PO creation
AI inventory: Rule-based reorder alerts	New Feature	7	80% of merchants receive 1+ alert/week	None
AI inventory: Expiry markdown suggestions	New Feature	8	Expired waste reduced 25%	Stock batch data
AI inventory: Shrinkage trend analysis (post-stock-take)	New Feature	9	Variance flagged within 1 hour of count	Stock take feature
Multichannel: WhatsApp commerce (receive order, auto-reply, queue)	New Feature	7-8	500 merchants process WhatsApp orders	None
Multichannel: Unified order queue with channel tags	New Feature	9	All orders (POS, web, WhatsApp) in one list	WhatsApp + storefront

Orders: Order-to-delivery handoff trigger	Improvement	8	1-tap delivery request from order screen	Delivery API
Orders: Repeat order templates for B2B customers	Improvement	7	B2B reorder time < 30 seconds	None
Orders: Order source tracking by channel	Improvement	7	100% of orders tagged by source	None
Storefront: Custom domain support (paid tier)	New Feature	8	100+ merchants on custom domains	Storefront MVP
Storefront: SEO tools (meta tags, Google indexing)	New Feature	9	Storefront pages appear in Google search	Storefront MVP
Storefront: Abandoned cart tracking	New Feature	9	Recovery rate > 5%	Storefront checkout
Product database: Scale to 500K products	Infrastructure	7-9	90% coverage in top 8 verticals	Phase 2 pipeline
Chat: Canned responses for common situations	Improvement	7	Response time drops 40%	None
Chat: Order context inline in thread	Improvement	8	Zero screen-switching for order queries	None
Manufacturer: Promotions LIVE (merchants opt-in, redemptions tracked at POS)	New Feature	7	5+ manufacturer promotions active; 1,000+ redemptions/month	Promotion engine + wallet
Manufacturer: Promotion performance reporting (lift, geo, redemption count)	New Feature	8	Each manufacturer sees ROI per promotion	Promotions live
Manufacturer: RRP (recommended retail price visible to merchants)	New Feature	9	RRP displayed for 50%+ of FMCG products	Product Content Management

Phase 3 Decision Gate (End of Month 9)

Month	Milestone	Gate Criteria	Decision If Not Met
9	100+ deliveries/week through platform	Counted from delivery API logs	Add delivery providers; subsidize first 500 deliveries to drive adoption
9	WhatsApp commerce live for 500+ merchants	Active = processed 1+ WhatsApp order in 30 days	Simplify WhatsApp setup; create video tutorial in Pidgin and Yoruba
9	Rule-based inventory alerts adopted by 80% of active merchants	Alert click-through rate > 30%	Refine alert timing and wording; test push vs. in-app delivery
9	Product database at 500K	Quality score on sample	Accelerate pharmacy and building materials verticals
9	Monthly payment volume N200M+	Transaction logs	Review pricing; increase merchant payment activation campaigns

9	5+ manufacturer promotions active with 1,000+ redemptions/month	Promotion engine logs and wallet transactions	If < 3 promotions active, increase manufacturer sales outreach; offer first promotion free (SyncSalez absorbs service fee)

Phase 4: Intelligence Layer

Months 10-12 | *Theme: Activate the data moat. Launch merchant AI. Pilot lending.*

With 5,000+ active merchants generating 50,000+ monthly transactions across 100,000+ unique SKUs, the cross-merchant data signals become statistically reliable. This phase activates the intelligence layer: AI-powered analytics for merchants, the lending pilot, and the internal data pipeline that will feed the B2B enterprise product in Phase 5.

> Phase 4 Outcome Target: 50+ merchants approved for lending pilot. AI analytics delivers 3+ actionable recommendations per merchant per week. Cross-merchant benchmarking live for top 10 product categories. 20+ manufacturers accessing Sales Dashboard. 3+ new product launches executed via the platform.

Feature / Deliverable	Type	Month	Success Metric	Dependency
AI analytics: Demand prediction (reorder recommendations based on velocity)	New Feature	10	Forecast accuracy > 70% at 7-day horizon	6+ months merchant data
AI analytics: Pricing recommendations (cross-merchant comparison)	New Feature	11	Merchants who follow pricing advice see 10%+ margin lift	5,000+ active merchants
AI analytics: Product recommendations (merchants who sell X also sell Y)	New Feature	11	5% of merchants add a recommended product within 7 days	Product affinity data
AI analytics: Anomaly alerts (unusual sales drops)	New Feature	10	Alert delivered within 4 hours of anomaly	3+ months of merchant data
AI analytics: Plain-language weekly summary (push notification)	New Feature	12	Open rate > 50%; merchant NPS lift +5 points	Analytics engine
Cross-merchant data pipeline: Aggregate sales velocity by product, geo, category	Infrastructure	10	Pipeline processes 100K+ transactions/day	Global product IDs active
Cross-merchant data pipeline: Pricing dispersion analysis	Infrastructure	10-11	Price range visible for top 10K products	Cross-merchant pipeline
Cross-merchant data pipeline: Seasonal pattern detection	Infrastructure	11	12-month seasonal curves for top 50 categories	12 months of data
Lending pilot: Merchant credit score (revenue trend, frequency, turnover, debt history)	New Feature	10-11	Score model validated on 500+ merchants	6+ months transaction data

Lending pilot: Partner API for 2-3 microfinance banks	New Feature	11	API live with at least 1 lender	Credit score model
Lending pilot: In-app loan application flow	New Feature	12	50+ merchants approved; default rate < 5%	Partner API
Storefront: Visual customizer (logo, banner, colors, layout)	New Feature	10	80% of storefront merchants customize their store	Storefront MVP
Storefront: Analytics (page views, conversion, top products, abandoned carts)	New Feature	11	Merchants check storefront analytics weekly	Storefront live
Customers: Customer lifetime value display	Improvement	10	Merchants identify top 10% of customers	Transaction history
Dashboard: Benchmarking panel (compare to similar stores)	Improvement	12	60% of merchants check benchmarks monthly	5,000+ merchants
Products: Barcode generation and Bluetooth label printing	Improvement	10	100+ merchants print labels weekly	Printer support from Phase 1
Products: Product performance score (margin, velocity, stock health)	Improvement	11	Red/yellow/green visible on product list	Analytics engine
Stock: FIFO enforcement for perishables (sell-this-batch-first prompts)	Improvement	10	FIFO compliance rate > 80% for perishable merchants	Batch data
Payment volume: N500M+/month	Target	12	Transaction logs	Payment system maturity
Manufacturer: Sales Dashboard MVP (volume, velocity, geo distribution)	New Feature	10-11	20+ manufacturers accessing dashboard monthly	Cross-merchant pipeline
Manufacturer: New Product Launch Distribution (targeted merchant invitations)	New Feature	11	3+ product launches executed; 200+ merchant opt-ins	Product Content Mgmt + segments
Manufacturer: Marketing Asset Library (images, social templates, videos)	New Feature	12	50+ asset sets uploaded; 500+ merchant downloads	Product Content Management
Manufacturer: Promotion wallet scaled (auto-settlement, monthly statements)	Improvement	11	Zero manual settlement interventions	Promotion wallet live

Phase 4 Decision Gate (End of Month 12)

Month	Milestone	Gate Criteria	Decision If Not Met
12	AI recommendations adopted by 40%+ of active merchants	Adoption = merchant acts on 1+ recommendation/week	Simplify recommendation UI; test SMS delivery for low-engagement merchants

12	Lending pilot: 50+ loans disbursed, < 5% default rate	Tracked via partner bank reporting	If default > 8%, tighten scoring model; pause new approvals until recalibrated
12	Cross-merchant pipeline processes 100K+ transactions/day	Pipeline monitoring dashboard	Scale infrastructure; prioritize data quality over volume
12	N500M+ monthly payment volume	Transaction logs	If below N300M, review payment activation funnel; consider incentive program
12	10,000+ monthly active merchants	Active = 5+ transactions in 30 days	If below 7,000, reallocate budget to acquisition; extend Phase 3 referral program
12	20+ manufacturers accessing Sales Dashboard monthly	Dashboard login and usage analytics	If < 10, review dashboard value proposition; add white-glove onboarding for top 30 FMCG brands

Phase 5: Platform Expansion

Months 13-15 | *Theme: Sell the intelligence. Optimize the supply chain. Deepen AI.*

The data moat is now generating reliable cross-merchant signals. This phase pilots the B2B enterprise intelligence product with 3-5 friendly brands. Supply chain optimization moves from discovery to performance management. AI models graduate from rule-based to ML-driven, trained on 12+ months of transaction data.

> Phase 5 Outcome Target: 3-5 enterprise pilot customers paying for market intelligence. Supply chain handles 5,000+ POs/month. ML demand forecasts outperform rule-based by 15%+. 10+ active bundle/rebate programs with measurable volume lift. Manufacturer dashboard upgraded to paid tier.

Feature / Deliverable	Type	Month	Success Metric	Dependency
B2B enterprise: Self-serve dashboard (filter by category, geo, time)	New Feature	13	3 pilot customers onboarded	Cross-merchant pipeline
B2B enterprise: Custom reports (demand trends, pricing, competitive analysis)	New Feature	14	Each pilot customer orders 2+ reports	Dashboard live
B2B enterprise: API access for enterprise BI integration	New Feature	15	1+ customer connects API to their BI stack	Dashboard + reports
AI inventory: ML demand forecasting (replaces rule-based)	New Feature	13	Forecast accuracy 15%+ better than rule-based	12+ months of data
AI inventory: Seasonal pre-stocking alerts	New Feature	14	Alerts sent 30 days before seasonal peak	Seasonal pattern data
AI inventory: Dead stock identification and clearance suggestions	New Feature	14	Dead stock value reduced 30%	6+ months inventory data
AI inventory: Cold-start demand estimation for new products	New Feature	15	New product demand estimate within 24 hours of listing	Cross-merchant affinity data
Supply chain: Supplier reliability scoring (on-time rate, accuracy, lead time)	New Feature	13	Ratings visible for 80% of active suppliers	PO history from Phase 3
Supply chain: 3-way matching (PO vs. delivery vs. invoice)	New Feature	14	Discrepancy flagged within 1 hour of goods receipt	PO + delivery tracking
Supply chain: Supplier onboarding portal	New Feature	14-15	200+ suppliers self-onboarded	Supply chain v1
Multichannel: Instagram/Facebook shop sync	New Feature	13	100+ merchants sync products to social shops	Product data + Meta API

Multichannel: AI product listing (photo to title, description, price)	New Feature	14	Listing creation time < 60 seconds	Product DB + AI models
Multichannel: Channel performance analytics	New Feature	15	Merchants see revenue split by channel	Unified order queue
Lending: Scale from pilot to general availability	New Feature	13	200+ active loans, default < 5%	Pilot results validated
Lending: Revenue share model with lending partners	Revenue	14	Facilitation fee generating N5M+/month	Lending at scale
Product database: Scale to 800K products	Infrastructure	13-15	Coverage audit: 95%+ in top 10 verticals	Ongoing pipeline
Storefront: Website templates expanded to 10	Improvement	13	Template selection covers all major verticals	Storefront v1
Delivery: Dispatch rider self-onboarding portal	New Feature	14	50+ independent riders active	Delivery system live
Delivery: Returns and failed delivery workflow	New Feature	15	Return processed within 24 hours	Delivery + stock sync
Manufacturer: Dashboard upgraded (competitive benchmarks, promotional ROI, category share)	New Feature	13	Paid tier conversion rate > 30% of active manufacturers	Dashboard MVP + pipeline
Manufacturer: Bundle and cross-sell programs (manufacturer-funded bundles at POS)	New Feature	14	10+ bundle programs active; 2,000+ redemptions/month	Promotions + affinity data
Manufacturer: Rebate and volume incentive programs	New Feature	15	20+ rebate programs active; merchant progress tracking live	Promotions + sales data
Manufacturer: Manufacturer-to-merchant messaging (frequency-capped, opt-in)	New Feature	14	50%+ of merchants opt in to at least 1 manufacturer channel	Messaging system + content mgmt

Phase 5 Decision Gate (End of Month 15)

Month	Milestone	Gate Criteria	Decision If Not Met
15	3+ enterprise pilot customers paying for intelligence	Signed contracts or active subscriptions	If zero paying customers, pivot to freemium data samples; extend pilot 3 months
15	ML forecasting outperforms rules by 15%+	A/B test across 1,000+ merchants	If < 10% improvement, keep rule-based as default; continue model training
15	Lending default rate < 5% at 200+ loans	Partner bank reporting	If default > 7%, tighten scoring; reduce max loan amount by 30%

15	Product database at 800K	Coverage audit	Accelerate automated ingestion; reduce manual curation dependency
15	10+ active bundle/rebate programs with measurable volume lift	Promotion engine logs; compare pre/post velocity	If < 5 programs, simplify program setup UX; offer co-funded pilot programs with top manufacturers

Phase 6: Data Monetization

Months 16-18 | *Theme: Monetize the moat. Complete the AI suite. Reach 1M products.*

The final phase launches the enterprise intelligence product commercially, completes the AI suite for merchants, reaches the 1M product database target, and builds the full marketplace signals infrastructure. At this point SyncSalez operates three revenue streams: transaction fees, SaaS subscriptions, and data/intelligence monetization.

> Phase 6 Outcome Target: Enterprise intelligence product generating revenue from 10+ paying customers. Product database reaches 1,000,000 products. Full AI suite operational for 60%+ of active merchants. Four distinct revenue streams active. 30+ manufacturers on full self-serve portal.

Feature / Deliverable	Type	Month	Success Metric	Dependency
B2B enterprise: Commercial launch (subscription tiers, sales pipeline)	New Feature	16	10+ paying enterprise customers	Pilot validation
B2B enterprise: Clean room capability (brands merge own data with SyncSalez signals)	New Feature	18	2+ brands in clean room beta	Enterprise product live
AI analytics: Conversational AI assistant (natural language + voice input)	New Feature	16-17	500+ merchants use voice queries weekly	AI analytics engine
AI analytics: Promotional effectiveness analysis	New Feature	17	Merchants measure promotion ROI within the app	Cross-merchant promo data
AI multichannel: Smart channel allocation (recommend where to push each product)	New Feature	17	5% revenue lift for merchants who follow recommendations	Channel analytics data
AI multichannel: Chatbot for buyer queries (auto-reply with product info + order link)	New Feature	18	30% of buyer questions answered without merchant intervention	WhatsApp commerce + AI
Supply chain: Price trend alerts for key inputs (cost-of-goods intelligence)	New Feature	16	Merchants adjust retail prices within 48 hours of supply price change	Supplier pricing data
Supply chain: Recommended supplier switching (better price, reliability, or terms)	New Feature	17	10%+ of merchants switch at least 1 supplier based on recommendation	Supplier scoring
Product database: Reach 1,000,000 products	Infrastructure	18	1M products, 95%+ accuracy on top 100K	Ongoing pipeline
Product database: Product lifecycle staging (introduction/growth/maturity/decline)	Intelligence	17	Lifecycle tag on 80% of products with 6+ months of data	12+ months sales velocity data
Delivery: Cost pass-through and markup options	Improvement	16	70% of delivery merchants set custom pricing	Delivery system

Lending: Direct lending exploration (if Model A proves viable)	Evaluation	18	Business case approved or rejected	12+ months lending data
Chat: Buyer-facing chatbot on storefront	New Feature	18	Reduces merchant response time by 50%	Storefront + AI
Dashboard: Real-time market intelligence panel for merchants	New Feature	17	Top 20% of merchants check market signals weekly	Cross-merchant data pipeline
Manufacturer: Sponsored Placement (paid storefront/catalogue positioning)	New Feature	16-17	CPM/CPC model live; N2M+ in placement revenue by Month 18	10K merchants + 2K storefronts
Manufacturer: Promotional effectiveness analysis for brands	New Feature	17	Each manufacturer sees lift vs. control for every promotion	Cross-merchant promo data
Manufacturer: Full self-serve portal (promotions, content, launches, assets, analytics)	New Feature	18	30+ active manufacturers managing their products autonomously	All manufacturer features

Phase 6 Decision Gate (End of Month 18)

Month	Milestone	Gate Criteria	Decision If Not Met
18	10+ paying enterprise intelligence customers	Active subscriptions with recurring revenue	If < 5, evaluate product-market fit; pivot to embedded analytics for large merchants
18	Product database at 1,000,000 products	Database count + quality audit	If < 800K, acceptable; continue pipeline acceleration into next planning cycle
18	Four revenue streams active and measurable	Transaction fees, subscriptions, data/lending, manufacturer engagement	If only 2-3 streams, focus next cycle on activating the weakest stream
18	AI suite used by 60%+ of active merchants	Weekly active AI feature usage	If < 40%, simplify AI UX; test proactive push over pull model
18	30+ active manufacturers on the platform	Managing content, running promotions, or accessing dashboards	If < 15, increase outbound sales; offer extended free tier to top 50 FMCG brands

Dependency Map

The following table shows the critical dependencies between features. A feature cannot ship until its dependencies are live and validated.

Feature	Depends On	Enables
Global Product Database	None (foundational)	Product auto-fill, supply chain discovery, cross-merchant intelligence, AI recommendations
Payment System	KYC integration, geo-tagging	Storefront checkout, lending, transaction revenue, settlement dashboard
Storefront	Template engine, payment system	Delivery integration, multichannel sales, custom domains, SEO, abandoned cart
Delivery Integration	Storefront live, order system	Returns workflow, rider portal, delivery cost pricing
Supply Chain Network	Product database at 300K+, supplier data	Auto-reorder, 3-way matching, supplier scoring, supply chain optimization
AI Merchant Analytics	6+ months transaction data, 5,000+ merchants	Lending credit score, demand prediction, pricing recommendations
Cross-Merchant Data Pipeline	Global product IDs, 50K+ monthly transactions	B2B enterprise product, merchant benchmarks, seasonal forecasting
B2B Enterprise Intelligence	Cross-merchant pipeline validated, 10K+ merchants	Clean room, API access, enterprise subscriptions
Lending / Credit Access	6+ months data, credit score model, bank partner	Direct lending evaluation, merchant lock-in
Multichannel Sales	Storefront, WhatsApp integration, unified order queue	Channel analytics, AI channel allocation, social shop sync
Manufacturer Engagement Layer	Product database with global IDs, payment system (for wallet/settlement), cross-merchant data pipeline (for dashboards)	Sponsored placement revenue, promotion fees, manufacturer content quality, enterprise intelligence adoption, retail media network

Risk Register

The following risks apply across the 18-month roadmap. Each risk is rated by likelihood and impact, with a specific mitigation action.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
CBN regulatory change halts payment processing	Medium	Critical	Operate through licensed PSSP partners (Paystack, Flutterwave) who absorb regulatory compliance. Maintain fallback to manual payment recording if API is suspended. Monitor CBN directives weekly.
Product database quality degrades at scale	High	High	Automated quality checks on every batch import. Community moderation queue with rejection workflow. Monthly random-sample audits on 1,000 products. Do not publish unverified products.
Low-end Android devices cannot run new features	High	High	Performance budget: every new screen must load in < 2 seconds on a Tecno Spark 10 (2GB RAM). Test every release on the 5 most common Transsion devices before rollout.
Merchant lending defaults exceed 8%	Medium	High	Start with Model A (data-to-lender, no balance sheet risk). Cap initial loans at N50,000. Require 6-month transaction history minimum. Pause lending if cohort default exceeds 8% for 2 consecutive months.
Delivery provider reliability is poor	Medium	Medium	Multi-provider routing with fallback. Rider ratings visible to merchants. Auto-escalate if rider does not pick up within 30 minutes. SLA in provider contracts.
Storefront adoption is low	Medium	Medium	Free subdomain removes cost barrier. Auto-generate storefront from catalogue with 1 tap. Share-to-WhatsApp button on every storefront page drives viral distribution.
Enterprise intelligence has no buyer	Medium	Medium	Run 3-5 free pilots before building the commercial product. Validate willingness to pay with signed LOIs before Phase 6 launch. Pivot to embedded merchant analytics if B2B demand is weak.
Engineering capacity bottleneck	High	High	Phase releases are scoped to 3-month blocks with explicit cut lines. If a phase runs over, the lowest-priority items roll to the next phase. Do not compress timelines by adding scope.
Cross-merchant data is too sparse to be useful	Medium	High	Set minimum thresholds before activating intelligence features (5,000 merchants, 50,000 transactions/month, 100K SKUs). Use synthetic benchmarks and public data to supplement until organic data reaches threshold.
WhatsApp/Meta API policy change breaks commerce flow	Low	High	Build WhatsApp integration as a channel adapter, not a core dependency. If Meta restricts API access, the order queue, storefront, and POS continue to function independently.
Merchants distrust manufacturer engagement features	Medium	Critical	Every manufacturer action is opt-in. No override capability. The merchant reviews, accepts, or declines every promotion, placement, and communication. UI must make merchant control explicit. Test with focus groups before launch.

Manufacturer adoption is slow (large FMCG companies are slow to adopt new platforms)	High	Medium	Start with 2-3 pilot brands who have existing distributor relationships with SyncSalez merchants. Show ROI data from the pilot. Let results sell the product. Do not build the full self-serve portal until 10+ manufacturers are active.
Promotion abuse floods merchants with irrelevant offers	Medium	Medium	Cap active promotions per manufacturer per merchant. Quality review on promotion content. Merchants rate promotions. Low-rated manufacturers face reduced distribution.
Promotion wallet settlement and reconciliation errors	Medium	High	Pre-fund only (no credit). Auto-deduct per redemption. Daily reconciliation reports. Monthly audit. Start with small promotion budgets during pilot phase. Scale wallet limits only after 3 months of clean settlement.

Success Metrics by Phase

The following table consolidates the north-star metric for each phase and the guardrail metrics that must not degrade.

Phase	North-Star Metric	Target	Guardrail (Must Not Degrade)
1 (M1-3)	Day-7 activation rate	60% of new signups complete 5+ sales by day 7	App crash rate < 1%. POS checkout time < 10 seconds.
2 (M4-6)	Monthly payment volume	N50M+ processed/month by end of Month 6	Activation rate holds at 60%+. Payment failure rate < 3%.
3 (M7-9)	Order fulfillment rate (delivery + supply chain)	100+ deliveries/week. 1,000+ POs/month.	Payment volume grows 20% M-o-M. Churn rate does not increase.
4 (M10-12)	AI recommendation adoption rate	40%+ of merchants act on 1+ recommendation/week	Lending default rate < 5%. Payment volume N500M+/month.
5 (M13-15)	Enterprise pilot revenue	3+ paying enterprise customers	Merchant churn stays below Phase 4 level. AI adoption holds.
6 (M16-18)	Revenue stream diversification	4 active revenue streams	Product database at 1M. Enterprise customers at 10+. AI adoption at 60%+. 30+ active manufacturers.

Revenue Model Timeline

Revenue streams activate at different phases. The goal is to reach three independent revenue streams by Month 18.

Revenue Stream	Activates	Mechanism	18-Month Target
Transaction Fees	Month 4	1.5% per payment processed (market standard, capped at N2,000)	N500M+ monthly volume. Primary revenue engine.
SaaS Subscriptions	Month 8	Free tier (500 products, basic POS). Growth tier (unlimited products, storefront, analytics). Pro tier (custom domain, advanced AI, multi-branch).	5,000+ paid subscribers across Growth and Pro tiers.
Lending Facilitation	Month 12	1-3% facilitation fee per loan originated via partner banks.	200+ active loans. N5M+/month in facilitation revenue.
Delivery Commission	Month 9	Small commission per delivery fulfilled through the platform.	1,000+ deliveries/month.
Supply Chain Fees	Month 14	1-2% transaction fee on POs placed through platform. Premium supplier listings.	5,000+ POs/month.
Enterprise Intelligence	Month 16	Subscription tiers for FMCG brands, distributors, investors.	10+ paying enterprise customers.
Manufacturer Promotion Fees	Month 7	10-20% service fee on manufacturer-funded promotion spend. Deducted from promotion wallet per redemption.	20+ active manufacturer promotions. Service fee revenue growing M-o-M.
Manufacturer Dashboard Subs	Month 13	Free tier (basic volume data). Paid tier (geo breakdowns, competitive benchmarks, promotional ROI). Monthly subscription.	20+ manufacturers on paid tier by Month 18.
Sponsored Placement (Retail Media)	Month 16	CPM/CPC fees for premium product placement on merchant storefronts and catalogues. Manufacturer bids, SyncSalez allocates impressions.	Highest long-term margin potential. N2M+ placement revenue by Month 18. Scales with storefront traffic.

Product Database Growth Trajectory

Month 3	Month 6	Month 9	Month 12	Month 15	Month 18
100,000	**300,000**	**500,000**	**650,000**	**800,000**	**1,000,000**

Operating Principles

1. Ship small, measure fast, iterate.

Every feature ships as the smallest testable version first. No feature spends more than 6 weeks in development without reaching real merchants. Measurement starts on day one of release, not after a polish cycle.

2. Offline-first is not optional.

Every feature must work on a Tecno Spark 10 with 2GB RAM and zero internet connectivity. If a feature requires an internet connection to function, it is a premium add-on, not a core capability. SQLite-first, sync-when-connected.

3. The product database is the asset. Protect data quality.

Every product in the database must have a verified name, accurate category, and at least one valid identifier (barcode, NAFDAC number, or manufacturer SKU). Unverified products do not enter the database. Quality degrades trust. Trust degrades the moat.

4. Revenue follows retention, not acquisition.

A merchant who churns at Month 2 generates zero lifetime revenue. A merchant who stays for 12 months generates transaction fees, subscription revenue, lending facilitation fees, and supply chain commissions. Retention is the multiplier on every revenue stream.

5. Data accumulation starts before data monetization.

Begin collecting and structuring cross-merchant product data from Month 1. Do not wait for scale to build the pipeline. The aggregation layer, normalization logic, and analytics infrastructure ship alongside the product database. Monetization activates later, but the data collection window is now.

6. Decision gates are real.

Each phase ends with a decision gate. If the gate criteria are not met, the response is to iterate on the current phase, not to push forward and hope. Shipping Phase 4 features on a Phase 2 foundation produces fragile outcomes.

7. Regulatory compliance is a prerequisite, not a feature.

KYC, PTSA routing, geo-tagging, NDPR data privacy. These are not line items on a roadmap. They are conditions that must be met before the dependent feature ships. No payment goes live without full CBN compliance. No data product launches without NDPR audit.

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